

Arcade Wise (they/them)

I design programs that get teenagers to ship real software, and I build the infrastructure that runs them.

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EXPERIENCE

Gap Year Fellow — Hack Club

Jun 2026 to present - Burlington, VT

Design and run **You Ship, We Ship** programs: challenges that get teenagers all across the globe to build and ship open-source projects for rewards, tangible and intangible. Built and ran so far: Tape to Tape, Entropy, and the smol program platform.

- **Entropy**: ship a project built on randomization, we send you a custom dice set (made by me!): 15 teen makers across 5 countries, 48 tracked build-hours in a short two-week run. I designed the incentive mechanics end to end, with wonderful art help from my coworker Nick Do.
- **Tape to Tape**: teens compose original tracks in Sonic Pi, I'll release on a real Bandcamp album. Designed the per-hour payout mechanism so participants get a stake in what they make.
- Build the infrastructure each program runs on: Astro sites on Cloudflare Pages, GitHub App-based repo provisioning, Vercel and Fillout API integrations, DNS automation via pull request, and custom review UIs for judging submissions, and all that's for a smaller program.

Systems Administrator — Cornell College CS Department

Oct 2025 to May 2026 - Mount Vernon, IA

- I ran the department's legacy Proxmox cluster and built out its replacement.
- Rebuilt the SOPs from a monolithic Google Doc into a MediaWiki with supporting scripts and tooling (automated user creation), so successors inherit a working system instead of folklore.

Freelance Software Engineer — Vivoh

Nov 2023 to May 2025 - remote

- Video streaming and peer-to-peer delivery in a C++ and Rust codebase; improved portability and build processes; QUIC transport work.

Volunteer Software Engineer — Folk Computer

ongoing

- Contributions to the projected-AR "tangible computing" system: PNG rendering, error handling, and a very cool orbital-mechanics demo I can show you.

PROJECTS

Lamplight — personal, "build out loud"

2026

A note-taking app + Realtalk-style reactive rules with Datalog: notes as facts, queries as views, explainable by default, and a replacement for the wallpaper! Working prototype currently; developed in public at arcades.agency/log.

aethopica — arcades.agency

ongoing

My personal website, as an SSG in C89 of all languages: essays, a weekly lab log, RSS and atproto syndication, IndieWeb h-card. The site itself is plain, semantic HTML, with all the bells and whistles I can add! It's been something to hack on for years, and I'll keep at it.

EDUCATION

Cornell College — BA, Computer Science & German Studies

2025 to 2029 (on leave)

On leave 2026–27 for the Hack Club fellowship.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Code — Rust, Python, C/C++, TypeScript/JavaScript - Astro/Next/JSX, Cloudflare Pages & Workers, Vercel - Linux and Proxmox administration - local-first architecture (Automerge, CRDTs)

Human — English (native), French and German (fluent), Spanish (basic)